The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Mother of All Dharmas

Āryasarvadharmamātṛkānāmadhāraṇī · Toh 996 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་མ་ཆོས་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་མྱུ་ག་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Mother of All Dharmas, known in Sanskrit as the Āryā Sarvadharmamātṛkā Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Chö Thamché Kyi Yum Shejawé Zung, is a short scripture centered on a protective incantation. Set at Śrāvastī, it opens with the Buddha instructing his attendant Ānanda to retain this dhāraṇī, which he describes as having been spoken by all the tathāgatas and as having the power to completely pacify all illnesses. The gods of the Pure Abodes then come forward and offer to recite the heart of the dhāraṇī, adding their own formula to the Buddha's teaching. This work is Toh 996 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collections of sacred formulas valued for their healing and protective efficacy.

In the language of India: āryā sarva dharma mātṛkā nāmṛ dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Mother of All Dharmas.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, retain the mudrā dhāraṇī called Mother of All Dharmas, which completely pacifies all illnesses. It has been spoken by all the tathāgatas, and I too now teach it:

tadyathā a varte a varte vi varte pi varte bhagama śuddhe prabhāsvare tāraṇe ukkhale mukkhale sarva dharmā vāśi vatani svāhā"

Then the gods of the Pure Abodes (Śuddhāvāsa) said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we shall recite the heart of this dhāraṇī:

tadyathā acche anale elule ekhuphe murdha anugate sarva dharma adhipataye prāpate jyosna kara adhigata jñāne viśuddhe vati svāhā"

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Ānanda and that entire assembly rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the dhāraṇī called Mother of All Dharmas.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.